

Silk and Sword

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Draft 3

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information

EXT. WIDOW'S FOREST - DUSK

A cold chill whistles through the branches of the Widow's Forest as Octavia walks towards her new prisoner. *

As she walks, there's crushed bones, broken bodies and webs tying what used to be victims to trees. She pays them no mind.

Celeste is held up by webs in a crucifixion pose a few feet off the ground, head slumped down, body limp. All colours on her clothes is gone, dim, monochrome. *

Octavia lifts Celeste's chin with a finger, only her grin is made visible as Celeste's eyes flutter open. *

OCTAVIA *

Well, aren't you a pretty little thing?

As Octavia's fingers slide off Celeste's chin, a small red web forms around her throat, like a collar, the end of the string wrapped around Octavia fingers. *

Octavia's full body is shown, a flash of light showing a shadow of spider legs sprouting from her back, the webs and bodies on the trees framing her in the shot. *

OCTAVIA (cont'd) *

Now, I assume you know who I am or you wouldn't have fought my spiders so violently before. So, who are you? The monster who killed so many of my pets? *

Celeste's eyes are glazed over, the mind control taking affect. *

CELESTE (V.O.) *

You're the monster here. *

CELESTE *

My name is Celeste. I am a Paladin of justice. *

OCTAVIA *

Very good, Celeste. We don't get many Paladins, we get so few visitors. So. Why are you here? *

CELESTE (V.O.) *

I'm not telling you a thing, I owe you nothing for the pain that you've caused! *

CELESTE

To kill the Crimson Widow. To
cleanse the world of your filth.
To make sure the world is free of
you.

A string around Celeste's neck snaps. Another around her
arm snaps. The glaze in her eyes flickers into clarity
for a moment.

Octavia stops smiling. Her grip on the string tightens.

She pulls Celeste forward sharply, her face close

OCTAVIA

There are always people like you,
aren't there? People who can't
just leave me alone. Your kind
never goes alone, there's always a
few of you wretched Paladins
following some grand path. So
where are they?

A sharp pain presses into Celeste's mind as memories
flash by. Octavia is looking for answers. She's going to
find them. Her friends. Her family. She's going to kill
them.

CELESTE (V.O.)

What are you doing? No. Stop.
Leave them alone. No, no, no,
don't hurt them! Not again!

Strings snap as Octavia looks up in shock.

CELESTE

I'll kill you before you lay
another web on them! I won't let
you hurt anyone else I love!

Celeste begins to strain against the webs, pulling away
from Octavia, more strings snap.

Octavia quickly ties Celeste back up, the mind control
re-established and Celeste returning to the slumped
position she had before.

OCTAVIA

(Visibly shaken) Well. You're...
quite a strong minded Paladin.
Aren't you?

Celeste doesn't answer. Octavia composes herself quickly

OCTAVIA (cont'd)

*

How delicious it will be when you
will give in to the sweet venom of
death and you shall join my
spiders once more.

I have had many that think
themselves as powerful as you, but
they have all broken. And so will
you.

Octavia turns and walks away, her face almost concerned
about Celeste.

*

*

There is a moment of stillness. Celeste remains limp from
the strings.

*

Then one snaps

Then another

And another

Unravelling and snapping rapidly until she falls to the
ground. The red of control slipping away into the blue of
her normal colors.

She looks up from her kneeling position, eyes focused and
clear

CELESTE

*

For those who have died before me.
I will not break.

*

END